7 On October 15, after several fruitless calls to Merwin, I got him and he said that the story would need revision. I chased down to his office and asked for Leo Margulies, being unwilling any longer to deal with Merwin.

Out came Merwin, to my annoyance. He told me what revision would be needed and, in brief, it meant throwing away the story, writing a much worse one—and with no guarantee of a sale then, either.

For the first and only time in my life, I openly lost my temper with an editor. I snatched up the manuscript, said, "Go to hell," and stalked angrily out of the office.

It was wrong of me to do that. An editor is entirely within his rights to reject a story, even a story he has ordered. I was not, however, able to think clearly at the time. Twice I had brought in what I had written for his opinions and suggestions—something I had never done for Campbell—and twice he had encouraged me to go ahead.

Furthermore, I had spent the summer working on it and now I felt humiliated. For five years now, when I had worked on a story I would sell it, and Gertrude had come to take that for granted. This time I would have to come to her with a failure and a wasted writing-summer, and I hated that.

I never submitted anything to Merwin again and, for a considerable time, thought of him only with anger.

8

Gertrude had just passed her thirtieth birthday and we still had no children. Recognizing the danger of increasing age in connection with childbirth, we had ceased taking precautions for the past couple of years, but there had been no result.

One difficulty, of course, was that Gertrude's periods were irregular, so it was difficult to tell when she might be ovulating and even more difficult to tell if she had skipped a period.

Of course, I didn't take the attitude that only women could possibly be responsible for any delay in having children, so I had myself examined and I was told I had a low sperm count. Between that and Gertrude's irregularity we realized, by the time we had moved into Windsor Place, that the chances for conception were lower than normal. The doctors we saw uniformly assured us that the chances were not zero and that we merely had to be patient, but as the